

Principles of Microeconomics

ECON 2020 Section 015 Spring 2025
T/Th 12:30 PM–1:45 PM Haley Center–3220

Instructor:	Sirazum Munira Haque	Office:	128 Miller Hall
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Webpage:	canvas.auburn.edu		

IMPORTANT → [Following Canvas is a MUST:](#)

Keep updated with all course posts and announcements on Canvas. Enabling Canvas notifications is strongly recommended.

Course Description

This course introduces the principles of microeconomics and how individuals and firms make decisions under scarcity. Topics include supply and demand, elasticity, government policies, market efficiency, production costs, and firm behavior under different market structures. Economic concepts are connected to real-world examples throughout the course.

Course Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Apply basic economic reasoning to individual and firm decision-making.
- Use supply and demand to analyze market outcomes and policy interventions.
- Evaluate efficiency, costs, and gains from trade in competitive markets.
- Compare firm behavior across competitive and imperfectly competitive market structures.

Course Materials

- **Recommended Textbook:** N. Gregory Mankiw, *Principles of Microeconomics*, 8th Edition. Any recent edition is acceptable.
- **In-Class Notes:** Students are encouraged to take detailed notes during class and review them when preparing for assignments and exams.

Examinations

- There are three midterm exams; the best two midterm scores count toward the final grade.
- There is one comprehensive final exam.
- Midterms are given during the regular 75-minute class period. Midterms are not formally cumulative, although course material builds across topics.
- Exams consist primarily of multiple-choice questions and may also include short-answer questions.
- Exams are closed-book and closed-notes except for one 3" × 5" notecard (front and back).
- Bring a non-graphing calculator, pencil, eraser, and student ID. Cell-phone calculators are not permitted.

Tentative Exam Dates:

- Midterm 1: February 18 (Tuesday)
- Midterm 2: March 25 (Tuesday)
- Midterm 3: April 24 (Thursday)
- Final Exam: May 5 (Monday), 10:30 A.M.–12:30 P.M.

Note: Midterm dates are tentative and may change according to the progress of the class. Any changes will be communicated in class and through Canvas.

Make-Up Exams

If you must miss a midterm exam for a legitimate and acceptable reason, you may take a make-up exam. The following guidelines apply:

- Make-up exams must be arranged within one week of the missed exam date and will be conducted in my office.
- Written documentation supporting the absence is required.
- Notify me before the exam day or, at the latest, on the day of the exam. If you notify me after the exam, you must provide a legitimate reason for the delay.
- If you notify me more than three days after the exam, you will receive a zero for the missed exam.
- There is no make-up exam for the final exam.
- Fraudulent documentation or excuses will be treated as an academic honesty violation.

Assignments

- There are five homework assignments, each consisting of approximately 40 questions and posted through Canvas.
- Students will typically have at least one week to complete each assignment.
- Assignments are mandatory. Late submissions and make-up assignments are not accepted.

Quizzes (Extra Credit Opportunity)

During the semester, there will be 6–8 unannounced quizzes, generally during the first or last 20 minutes of class. Quizzes may include multiple-choice and short-answer questions based on material from recent lectures.

- The lowest quiz score will be dropped.
- Students may earn up to 10 bonus points toward the final course grade based on quiz performance.
- Missed quizzes cannot be retaken.

Attendance and Participation

- Students are expected to attend class regularly and participate meaningfully in class discussions and activities.
- Attendance will be taken randomly.
- More than four unexcused absences may result in a grade of **FA**.

Grading & Evaluation

Achievement in this course will be assessed through completion of the following activities:

Item	Number Counted	Individual Percentage	Total Percentage
Assignments	5	6%	$5 \times 6 = 30\%$
Midterms (Best 2 of 3)	2	20%	$2 \times 20 = 40\%$
Final Exam	1	30%	$1 \times 30 = 30\%$
Pop Quizzes	Best 7	–	Up to 10 bonus points
Total			100% + bonus

The student's final grade will be determined by the total percentage earned from assignments, midterms, and the final exam, plus any bonus points earned through quizzes. After rounding the total course percentage to the nearest whole percentage point, letter grades will be assigned according to the following scale:

A	B	C	D	F
90% and above	80%–89%	70%–79%	60%–69%	59% and under

Academic Support

Information about Auburn University's academic support services is available at <https://academicsupport.auburn.edu/>.

Academic Dishonesty & Cheating

All portions of the Auburn University Student Academic Honesty Code (Title XII) apply to this class. Academic honesty violations or alleged violations will be handled according to Auburn University procedures. See the [Student Policy eHandbook](#).

Disability Accommodations

Students who need disability-related accommodations should work with Auburn University's Office of Accessibility. Please notify me as early as possible once accommodations are approved so that appropriate arrangements can be made. See [Office of Accessibility](#).

Classroom Behavior

Students are expected to follow Auburn University classroom behavior policies. Disruptive behavior or nonacademic use of devices that interferes with the learning environment is not permitted. See the [Student Policy eHandbook](#).

Course Communication

Announcements concerning the class will typically be made through Canvas or Auburn email. You are responsible for checking both regularly. Please use your Auburn email account when contacting me about the course.

Office Hours

Office hours are available by appointment. Email me at szh0152@auburn.edu to schedule a time.

Course Expectations

1. Keep up with the course material each week by completing assigned readings, reviewing lecture slides and notes, and attending class regularly.
2. Check Canvas and Auburn email regularly for announcements, reminders, assignments, and schedule changes.
3. Ask questions early if something is unclear. You are welcome to ask questions during class, attend office hours, or send an email. I typically respond to emails within 1–2 days.

Tentative Course Outline

Topics	Assignments & Exams
Chapter 1 $\Rightarrow$ Ten Principles of Economics	
Chapter 2 $\Rightarrow$ Thinking Like an Economist	Assignment 1
Chapter 3 $\Rightarrow$ Interdependence and the Gains from Trade	
Chapter 4 $\Rightarrow$ The Market Forces of Supply and Demand	
Chapter 5 $\Rightarrow$ Elasticity and Its Applications	Assignment 2
	Midterm Exam 1
Chapter 6 $\Rightarrow$ Supply, Demand, and Government Policies	
Chapter 7 $\Rightarrow$ Consumers, Producers, and Efficiency of Markets	Assignment 3
Chapter 8 $\Rightarrow$ Applications of Costs and Taxation	
	Midterm Exam 2
Chapter 13 $\Rightarrow$ The Costs of Production	
Chapter 14 $\Rightarrow$ Firms in Competitive Markets	Assignment 4
Chapter 15 $\Rightarrow$ Monopoly	
Chapter 16 $\Rightarrow$ Monopolistic Competition	Assignment 5
Chapter 17 $\Rightarrow$ Oligopoly	
	Midterm Exam 3
	Final Exam

Note: This plan is tentative and may change according to the progress of the class. Students will be notified of any changes through Canvas and Auburn email.